

just impact my ability to accomplish a long-term goal, it also shifted the way I viewed myself. I went from feeling like a dummy for all the student loan debt I took out to embracing what was possible for me and the things I was accomplishing in the midst of slowly paying off the loans.

Working within our limitations is what allowed Eric and me to choose creative living situations, like house-sitting in a log cabin for a year and full-time RV-ing for two years. Those choices afforded us what we love, as we prioritized job flexibility and investing in my graduate education. We found ways to get the things we wanted despite what felt like hindrances at the time.

As you think about your own circumstances, it's possible that reframing your thoughts about your season will open up possibilities in the way you live and spend. Are there creative decisions you can make that will allow you to meet your money goals? How can your current "limitations" inform your spending and next steps?

Even if you're stepping out of a difficult season or financial hurdles, the beautiful thing about healing and change is that it happens *as you are going*.

You may need to take it easy at times, but it doesn't mean stagnation. New experiences, forward progress, and trusted people all offer great opportunities to shift spending habits and uncover capabilities above and beyond what you may have thought possible.

I, for one, never would have thought nontraditional housing would be what helped me pay off debt, but limitations brought to the surface new ideas. These experiences forever shaped me and played a part in who I am becoming.

You too are in your process of becoming, and your season is what's shaping that, not hindering it. So, while your current season may not afford you *everything* you love, embracing it and prioritizing your values is how you get what matters most.

And that's a wrap on part 1. Hopefully by now you have a solid grasp on how you define "what you love" and know what the journey looks like to find and buy those things. You also know that buying what you love doesn't mean spending your whole paycheck on all the restaurant appetizers, nor is it all going to fulfill your deepest needs for quality time. It's somewhere in the radical middle of them. And to find that radical middle, you have to build a habit of curiosity. Curiosity that seeks to understand without